

Assignment 1 Reflection

1. Which of the tools introduced so far have you had previous experience with? Which were new?

Answer: I have had experience with Spyder and VS Code. I have used GitHub and pytest but not to the extent I will for this class. I like using pytest but I can see where my formatter/linter Ruff likes to break it.

2. What part of this assignment was the most difficult?

Answer: I had to dive into the test script to better understand the exact reason my code was failing. I did like that so I learned more about pytest. VS Code has a lot of auto completion tools now and sometimes they were wrong. It's easy to auto complete without thinking.

3. To what extent did you find yourself looking things up online? Describe the tactics you used to find the information you needed -- and how you filtered out the content that wasn't relevant or helpful.

Answer: I looked up the XOR operator using Google and it quickly told me what it was. I didn't have to filter much. I had to look up how to prevent my formatter from formatting task 3 lines which were too long. In that case I used ChatGPT and it gave a few examples of the comment I needed to add to turn the formatter off for a block of code. I knew what I was looking for and I thought ChatGPT would do a better job than a generic Google search for the formatter problem.

4. I hope you made allies and friends in doing this assignment. Did you work with others? What was that like?

Answer: I did not reach out on Piazza yet. I'm slightly concerned with the pace and working with others is hard to coordinate with work. I think pytest is a frenemy. I do like getting experience with it though and I agree with test driven development.

5. Describe one thing that you learned while working on this lesson that stood out as useful or interesting.

Answer: In DS701 I started using GitHub but for this class when I saw the repo online I forked the repo and found that extremely helpful. I want to use version control but this also organized all of the files for me. It was great. I never really used pytest and for this assignment I thought it was a good introduction to it. Easier code to understand what the test cases are looking for.